

Standard Operating Procedure

Pain Assessment and Management

«Hospital Name» — Supports COP.17.b through COP.17.d

SOP No.	[Hospital to define]	Version	1.0
Effective Date	_____	Review Frequency	Annual, or on change
Prepared By	Quality Coordinator Name: _____ Signature: _____		
Approved By	Medical Superintendent Name: _____ Signature: _____		

1. Purpose

This SOP describes how «Hospital Name» screens every patient for pain, assesses it in detail when needed, and manages it with monitored, adjusted treatment.

2. Scope

Applies to every patient at admission and throughout their stay.

3. Responsibility

Doctor / Nurse: screens, assesses, initiates relief, and monitors response.

4. Procedure

1. Screen every patient for pain on admission.
2. If pain is the predominant symptom, or the patient is post-operative, complete a detailed assessment covering intensity (using a validated scale), character, frequency, location, and duration/radiation.
3. Initiate pain relief per the hospital's adopted approach (e.g. the WHO analgesic ladder), matched to intensity.
4. Reassess pain after intervention, and adjust treatment based on the response — never leave a treatment unadjusted when it isn't working.

5. Records

Supported by all 6 records in the COP.17 Required Records pack.

6. Related Documents

- HCO_COP_17_v2_REWRITE_DRAFT — COP.17 policy

7. Review

Reviewed annually.

8. References

- World Health Organization. (2018). WHO Guidelines for the Pharmacological and Radiotherapeutic Management of Cancer Pain in Adults and Adolescents. <https://apps.who.int/iris/handle/10665/279700> —

the source of the three-step analgesic ladder approach this SOP references for matching treatment to pain intensity.